

EUROPEAN COURT OF HUMAN RIGHTS
COUR EUROPÉENNE DES DROITS DE L'HOMME

FOURTH SECTION

CASE OF SOKOLOV AND OTHERS v. RUSSIA

(Applications nos. 2097/22 and 24 others –
see appended list)

JUDGMENT

STRASBOURG

28 March 2024

This judgment is final but it may be subject to editorial revision.



In the case of Sokolov and Others v. Russia,

The European Court of Human Rights (Fourth Section), sitting as a Committee composed of:

Branko Lubarda*, President*,
Armen Harutyunyan,
Ana Maria Guerra Martins*, judges*,
and Viktoriya Maradudina, *Acting Deputy Section Registrar,*

Having deliberated in private on 7 March 2024,

Delivers the following judgment, which was adopted on that date:

PROCEDURE

1. The case originated in applications against Russia lodged with the Court under Article 34 of the Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms ("the Convention") on the various dates indicated in the appended table.

2. The Russian Government ("the Government") were given notice of the applications.

THE FACTS

3. The list of applicants and the relevant details of the applications are set out in the appended table.

4. The applicants complained of the disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies. Some applicants also raised other complaints under the provisions of the Convention.

THE LAW

I. JOINDER OF THE APPLICATIONS

5. Having regard to the similar subject matter of the applications, the Court finds it appropriate to examine them jointly in a single judgment.

II. JURISDICTION

6. The Court observes that the facts giving rise to the alleged violations of the Convention occurred prior to 16 September 2022, the date on which the Russian Federation ceased to be a party to the Convention. The Court therefore decides that it has jurisdiction to examine the present applications (see *Fedotova and Others v. Russia* [GC], nos. 40792/10 and 2 others, §§ 68-73, 17 January 2023).

III. ALLEGED VIOLATION OF ARTICLE 11 OF THE CONVENTION

7. The applicants complained principally of disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies, namely their arrest in relation to the dispersal of these assemblies and their conviction for administrative offences. They relied, expressly or in substance, on Article 11 of the Convention.

8. The Court refers to the principles established in its case-law regarding freedom of assembly (see *Kudrevičius and Others v. Lithuania* [GC], no. 37553/05, ECHR 2015, with further references) and proportionality of interference with it (see *Oya Ataman v. Turkey*, no. 74552/01, ECHR 2006-XIV, and *Hyde Park and Others v. Moldova*, no. 33482/06, 31 March 2009).

9. In the leading cases of *Frumkin v. Russia,* no. 74568/12, ECHR 2016 (extracts), *Navalnyy and Yashin v. Russia,* no. 76204/11, 4 December 2014 and *Kasparov and Others v. Russia,* no. 21613/07, 3 October 2013, the Court already found a violation in respect of issues similar to those in the present case.

10. Having examined all the material submitted to it, the Court has not found any fact or argument capable of persuading it to reach a different conclusion as to the admissibility and merits of these complaints. Having regard to its case-law on the subject, the Court considers that in the instant case the interferences with the applicants' freedom of assembly were not "necessary in a democratic society".

11. These complaints are therefore admissible and disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention.

IV. OTHER ALLEGED VIOLATIONS UNDER WELL-ESTABLISHED CASE-LAW

12. Some applicants submitted other complaints which also raised issues under the Convention and its Protocols, given the relevant well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table). These complaints are not manifestly ill-founded within the meaning of Article 35 § 3 (a) of the Convention, nor are they inadmissible on any other ground. Accordingly, they must be declared admissible.

13. Having examined all the material before it, the Court concludes that these complaints also disclose violations of the Convention and its Protocols in the light of its findings in *Butkevich v. Russia*, no. 5865/07, §§ 63-65, 13 February 2018, *Tsvetkova and Others v. Russia*, nos. 54381/08 and 5 others, §§ 115-31, 10 April 2018, and *Korneyeva v. Russia*, no. 72051/17, §§ 34-36, 8 October 2019, as to various aspects of unlawful deprivation of liberty of organisers or participants of public assemblies; *Karelin v. Russia*, no. 926/08, §§ 58-85, 20 September 2016, concerning the absence of a

prosecuting party in the proceedings under the Code of Administrative Offences (the CAO); *Martynyuk v. Russia*, no. 13764/15, §§ 38-42, 8 October 2019, relating to the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal against the sentence of administrative detention.

V. REMAINING COMPLAINTS

14. Some applicants raised further additional complaints under Article 6 of the Convention concerning other aspects of fairness of the administrative-offence proceedings. In view of the findings above, the Court considers that there is no need to deal separately with these remaining complaints.

VI. APPLICATION OF ARTICLE 41 OF THE CONVENTION

15. Regard being had to the documents in its possession and to its case-law (see in particular *Navalnyy and Others v. Russia* [Committee], nos. 25809/17 and 14 others, § 22, 4 October 2022), the Court finds it reasonable to award the sums indicated in the appended table.

FOR THESE REASONS, THE COURT, UNANIMOUSLY,

1. *Decides* to join the applications;

2. *Holds* that it has jurisdiction to deal with these applications as they relate to facts that took place before 16 September 2022;

3. *Declares* the complaints under Article 11 of the Convention and the other complaints under the well-established case-law of the Court, as set out in the appended table, admissible, and *finds* that there is no need to examine separately the remaining complaints under Article 6 of the Convention;

4. *Holds* that these applications disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention;

5. *Holds* that there has been a violation of the Convention and the Protocols thereto as regards the other complaints raised under the well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table);

6. *Holds*
   (a) that the respondent State is to pay the applicants, within three months, the amounts indicated in the appended table, to be converted into the currency of the respondent State at the rate applicable at the date of settlement;

(b) that from the expiry of the above-mentioned three months until settlement simple interest shall be payable on the above amounts at a rate equal to the marginal lending rate of the European Central Bank during the default period plus three percentage points.

Done in English, and notified in writing on 28 March 2024, pursuant to Rule 77 §§ 2 and 3 of the Rules of Court.

Viktoriya Maradudina	Branko Lubarda
Acting Deputy Registrar	President

APPENDIX

List of applications raising complaints under Article 11 of the Convention
(disproportionate measures against organisers and participants of public assemblies)

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
1.	2097/22 14/12/2021	**Pavel Valeryevich SOKOLOV** 1996	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Krasnoyarsk 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Krasnoyarsk Regional Court 17/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
2.	2108/22 13/12/2021	**Aleksey Aleksandrovich SHIRYAYEV** 1994	Konstantin Mikhaylovich Zinovyev Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 16/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings,	4,000
3.	2172/22 10/12/2021	**Artem Vitalyevich ANKUDIMOV** 1994	Olimpiada Valentinovna Usanova Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 10/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
4.	2212/22 09/12/2021	**Irina Nikolayevna SOKOVA** 1999	Konstantin Mikhaylovich Zinovyev Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 2 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 10/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 21/04/2021 until 22/04/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
5.	2545/22 20/12/2021	**Andrey Yuryevich ILLARIONOV** 1971	Yevgeniy Vyacheslavovich Antokhin Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 01/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
6.	2581/22 28/12/2021	**Yegor Anatolyevich FILIMONOV** 1985	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 29/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
7.	2612/22 09/12/2021	**Yekaterina Dmitriyevna MARKOVA** 2002	Konstantin Mikhaylovich Zinovyev Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 10/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
8.	2861/22 09/12/2021	**Vadim Yevgenyevich SEROV** 1986	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Volgograd 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Volgograd Regional Court 09/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 21/04/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
9.	2871/22 09/12/2021	**Filipp Nikolayevich KOZLOV** 1984	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 09/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
10.	2935/22 21/12/2021	**Nikolay Gennadyevich BAKHALKHANOV** 1995	Yelena Yuryevna Pershakova Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Krasnoyarsk 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Krasnoyarsk Regional Court 24/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
11.	2995/22 27/12/2021	**Aleksandr Sergeyevich KUZIKOV** 1973	Yelena Yuryevna Pershakova Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Perm 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Perm Regional Court 05/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
12.	3014/22 27/12/2021	**Svetlana Ruslanovna SHILO** 1969	Yelena Yuryevna Pershakova Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention of 3 days	Moscow City Court 05/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station after compiling an offence report from 31/01/2021 until 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
13.	3139/22 02/12/2021	**Danila Andreyevich BARYSHNIKOV** 1988	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Ufa 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Supreme Court of the Bashkortostan Republic 02/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 21/04/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
14.	3183/22 11/12/2021	**Lyubov Nikolayevna BORMOTOVA** 1983	Sofya Zurabovna Sharangiya Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 03/06/2021 (final judgment served on the applicant on 11/06/2021)	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
15.	3236/22 16/12/2021	**Yegor Igorevich TORGOV** 1998	Konstantin Mikhaylovich Zinovyev Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 16/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 23/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
16.	3312/22 15/12/2021	**Anatoliy Nikolayevich MIGUNOV** 1989	Andrey Olegovich Valenkov Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 16/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
17.	13158/22 02/02/2022	**Nikita Vyacheslavovich GULYAYEV** 2001	Darya Dmitriyevna Aksenova Kolomna	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 03/08/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
18.	15890/22 22/03/2022	**Ilya Sergeyevich FESHCHENKO** 1994	Darya Dmitriyevna Aksenova Kolomna	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 11/10/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
19.	22650/22 17/04/2022	**Vasiliy Grigoryevich CHERKASOV** 2000		Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 21/10/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings,	3,500

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
20.	23362/22 20/04/2022	**Konstantin Sergeyevich SOKOLOV** 1995		Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 17/01/2022	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
21.	23582/22 15/04/2022	**Igor Dmitriyevich RODIONOV** 1991		Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 25/10/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
22.	23593/22 14/04/2022	**Karina Ashotovna TAMRAZYAN** 2001	Darya Dmitriyevna Aksyenova Kolomna	Protest against constitutional amendments Moscow 15/07/2020	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 15/10/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 15/07/2020 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
23.	25470/22 26/04/2022	**Pavel Nikolayevich VIRGUSH** 1993	Nataliya Andreyevna Baranova Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Novosibirsk 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 12,000	Novosibirsk Regional Court 28/10/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling an offence report, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative/ criminal charges	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
24.	31286/22 18/05/2022	**Petr Mikhaylovich SINITSYN** 1985	Aleksey Vladimirovich Bushmakov Yekaterinburg	Anti-war protest Yekaterinburg 24/02/2022	article 20.2 § 2 of CAO	detention of 9 days	Sverdlovsk Regional Court 03/03/2022	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO	5,000
25.	31289/22 18/05/2022	**Olga Gennadyevna GREBENKINA** 1995	Aleksey Vladimirovich Bushmakov Yekaterinburg	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Yekaterinburg 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Sverdlovsk Regional Court 10/02/2022	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500

[1] Plus any tax that may be chargeable to the applicants.